LAB ASSIGNMENT V : HEURISTIC EVALUATION

SYSTEM EVALUATED: GeM (Government e-Marketplace) — Tractors Category

NAME: Jasjot Singh

Evaluation to be done by other Group

PART I : HEURISTIC EVALUATION BASED ON THE GIVEN PRINCIPLES

Rating: 0 = minimum severity, 5 = maximum severity.

S.No.	Heuristic Evaluation Parameter	Violation if any	Severity 0–5	Ways to improve
1	**User Control**	Search, category tiles, filters, Save for Later and Cancel/close on the bid modal give good control. However, filters use single-select radio buttons, a buyer has no visible “Create Bid” route, and nothing shows how to edit or withdraw a submitted bid.	**3**	Use multi-select checkbox filters, add a clear Create Bid / Raise Requirement path for buyers, and allow edit or withdraw before the deadline.
2	**Human Limitations**	Two stacked navigation bars (11 items), three search entry points (header icon, hero search, Products/Bids tabs) and terms like EMD and Base/Reserve Price add load. Key facts are split between the summary card and tabs.	**3**	Consolidate navigation and search, keep key bid facts in one summary and use progressive disclosure for the rest.
3	**Accommodation**	Screen Reader, Hindi toggle and Skip to Main support different users. However, no text-size or contrast controls and no other regional languages are visible, and buyers and sellers get the same wording.	**2**	Add A− / A / A+ and high-contrast controls, more language options and role-based labels.
4	**Linguistic Clarity**	Tooltips such as “What is a GeM Bid?” and the EMD “?” help, but “Base / Reserve Price”, “GeM Pool”, “OEM Corner” and “GeM Verified” vs “GeM Certified” are not explained. Category naming varies (Agricultural Tractors vs Tractors).	**3**	Use plain-language labels with the formal term in brackets, one name per category and short explainers for each badge.
5	**Aesthetic Integrity**	Government identity is strong, with a consistent blue/orange palette and clear orange CTAs. However, the hero's right half is empty, the featured tractor image is washed out under a blue overlay, and some secondary text is pale.	**2**	Fill or remove the empty hero space, use a crisp tractor image and raise contrast on secondary text.
6	**Simplicity**	The core path (search, listing, bid details, submit) is short and the bid modal is clean. Redundant search entry points and the double navigation bar add avoidable complexity.	**2**	Merge the duplicate search entry points and trim the secondary navigation.

7	**Predictability**	Participate in Bid opens a modal as expected, but the Tractors tile looks pre-selected without a click, the tile says 1,248 products while the listing shows 8 results, and the listing shows existing ministry bids when a buyer expects products to buy.	**3**	Remove the permanent highlight, reconcile product and result counts and explain what the listing represents.
S.No.	**Heuristic Evaluation Parameter**	**Violation if any**	**Severity 0–5**	**Ways to improve**
8	**Accuracy**	A bid labelled Active, closing in 2h 17m, shows a bid-close date of 24 Sep 2024 and delivery by 31 Dec 2024. Listing photos do not appear to match the models (a green tractor for Mahindra YUVO 415 DI), and counts differ between screens.	**4**	Keep bid dates and countdowns consistent, show real model photos and reconcile all counts.
9	**Technical Clarity**	Cards show HP plus a few chips (4WD, power steering, gears), but the chips differ per tractor and the full specification sits behind a tab. Engine, PTO power, lift capacity and warranty are not shown consistently.	**3**	Use one standard specification set on every card and surface 4–5 key specs in the bid summary.
10	**Fulfillment**	Users can find a tractor and reach the bid form in a few clicks, and the modal summarises item, quantity, reserve price and EMD. No total value, EMD payment status or confirmation step appears in the flow.	**2**	Show the total quoted value, EMD status and a clear success screen with the next steps.
11	**Consistency**	Breadcrumbs differ (Home / Agricultural Tractors vs Home / Tractors / Bid), the card says Base Price while the detail page says Base / Reserve Price, spec chips vary and two trust badges (Verified, Certified) are used.	**3**	Adopt one naming scheme, one price label and one badge system across all screens.
12	**User Support**	Help in the main menu, the “What is a GeM Bid?” tooltip and the Q&A tab are useful. No live chat or contact option is visible, and the bid modal has no help on quote rules.	**2**	Add contextual help in the modal, a visible helpdesk or chat entry and a first-time buyer guide.
13	**Precision**	Brand and engine-power filters exist, but both are single-select. There are no filters for price, features (4WD), state or ministry, or bid deadline, and the result count is easy to miss.	**3**	Add multi-select brand and HP, price, feature, state and deadline filters with a visible result count.
14	**Forgiveness**	Cancel, the close icon and the T&C checkbox help prevent mistakes. However, the quoted price defaults to 0 with no rule hint, Confirm looks enabled before the checkbox is ticked, and there is no visible undo or edit after submission.	**3**	Add inline validation, disable Confirm until the checkbox is ticked and allow edit or withdraw before the deadline.

15	**Responsiveness**	Countdown badges and the notification bell give some status feedback. In the captured flow there are no loading, inline validation or success states, and mobile behaviour could not be verified.	**2**	Add loading and success states, field-level error messages and verify the layout on mobile.

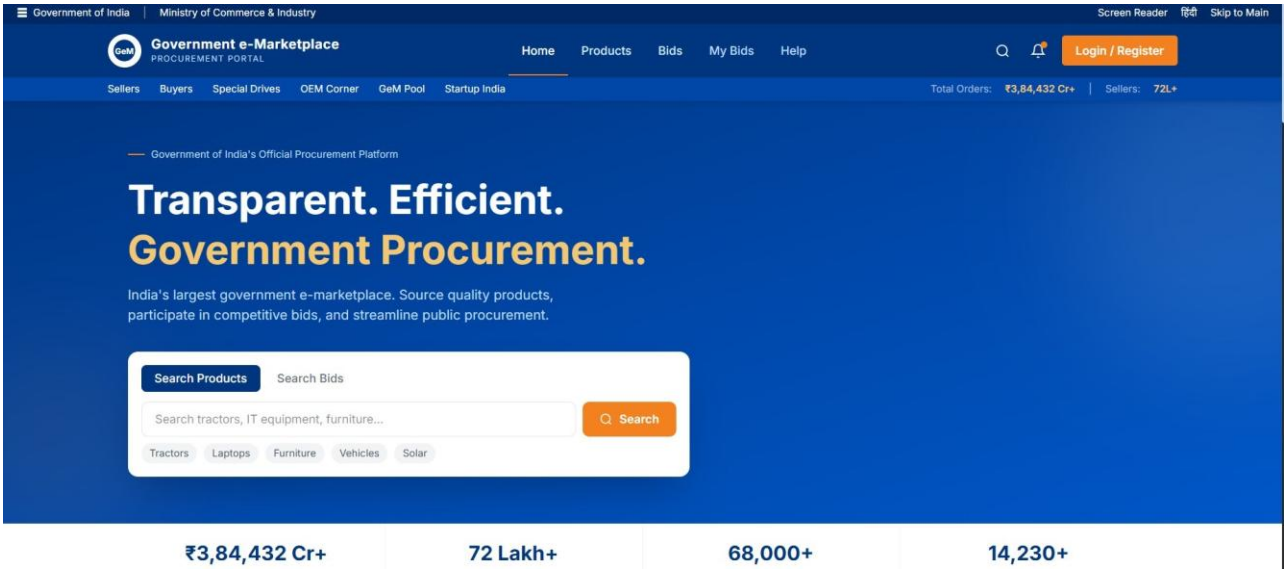
TOTAL SCORE: 40 / 75

Overall assessment: GeM has a strong government identity, a consistent visual style, a visible Tractors entry point (search chip, category tile and featured banner), helpful tooltips and a clean bid modal. Major issues are inaccurate or inconsistent data (bid dates, counts, tractor photos), single-select filters, inconsistent naming and specifications, unclear buyer vs seller paths, missing text-size and contrast controls, low-contrast secondary text and limited validation and status feedback.

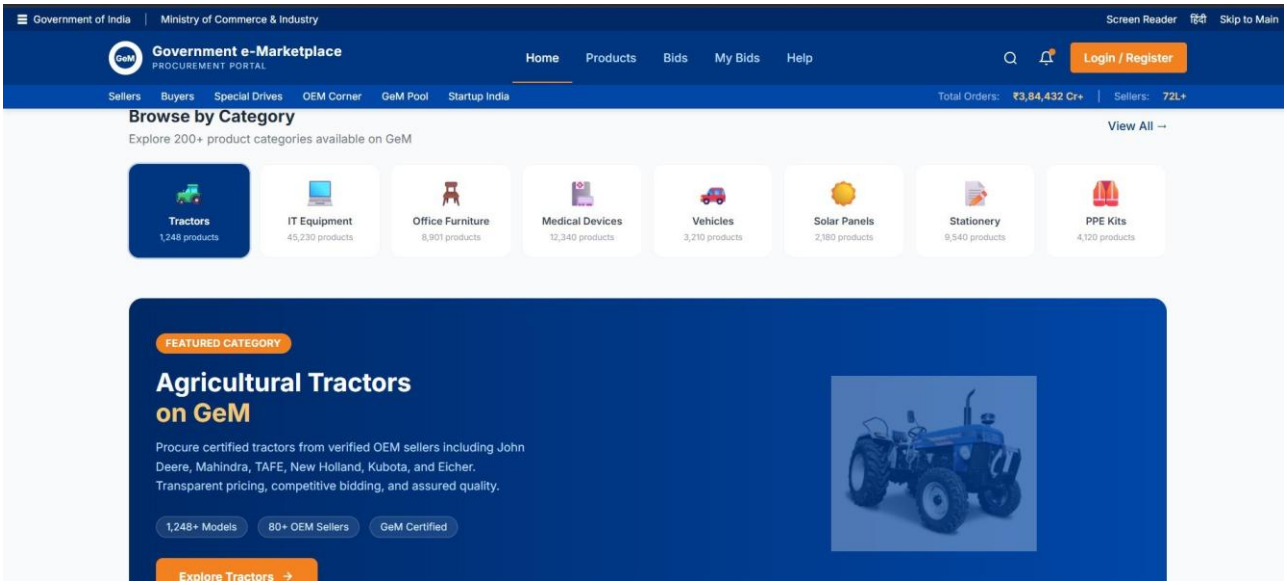
PART II : OTHER OBSERVATIONS (OTHER THAN THE GIVEN PRINCIPLES)

S.NO	OBSERVATIONS	COMMENTS
1	**Homepage Hero**	The right half of the hero is empty blue space. Add tractor imagery, a key-stats panel or tighten the hero height.
2	**Navigation & Search**	Two navigation bars and three search entry points overlap. Merge them into one primary menu and one search with Products / Bids tabs.
3	**Category Browse**	The Tractors tile looks permanently selected and shows 1,248 products while the listing shows 8 results. Remove the highlight and reconcile the counts.
4	**Featured Banner**	The tractor image in the Agricultural Tractors banner is faded under a blue overlay. Use a sharp, high-resolution image.
5	**Listing Imagery**	Card photos are stock images that do not appear to match the listed model. Use real model photos from the OEM.
6	**Listing Cards**	Star ratings and review counts appear on bids and the compare icon has no label. Clarify what the ratings mean and label the icon.
7	**Bid Details Layout**	A large blank area sits inside the overview card while specifications are hidden in tabs. Move key specs into the empty space.
8	**Low-Contrast Text**	Pale grey labels (Ministry, Department, product counts, Total Orders) are hard to read. Raise contrast to the accessibility standard.
9	**Bid Submission Modal**	Add a total-value calculation, quote-rule hint, document or EMD status and a disabled Confirm until the checkbox is ticked.
10	**Buyer vs Seller Paths**	Participate in Bid is a seller action, yet buyers land on the same listing. Add a clear Create Bid path for department buyers.

Screenshots to Attach: Homepage, Browse by Category, tractor listing, bid details and the Submit Your Bid modal..

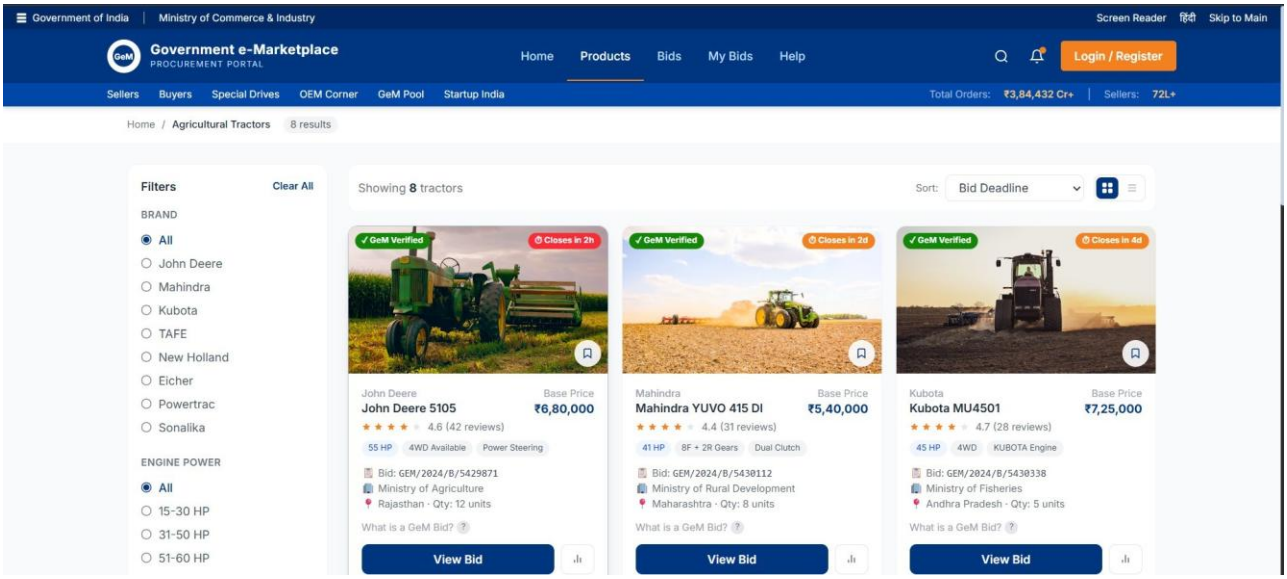

Government of India | Ministry of Commerce & Industry
Screen Reader
हिंदी
Skip to Main
Government e-Marketplace
PROCUREMENT PORTAL
Home
Products
Bids
My Bids
Help
Login / Register
Sellers
Buyers
Special Drives
OEM Corner
GeM Pool
Startup India
Total Orders: ₹3,84,432 Cr+ | Sellers: 72L+
Government of India's Official Procurement Platform
Transparent. Efficient.
Government Procurement.
India's largest government e-marketplace. Source quality products, participate in competitive bids, and streamline public procurement.
Search Products
Search Bids
Search tractors, IT equipment, furniture...
Search
Tractors
Laptops
Furniture
Vehicles
Solar
₹3,84,432 Cr+
72 Lakh+
68,000+
14,230+

Homepage



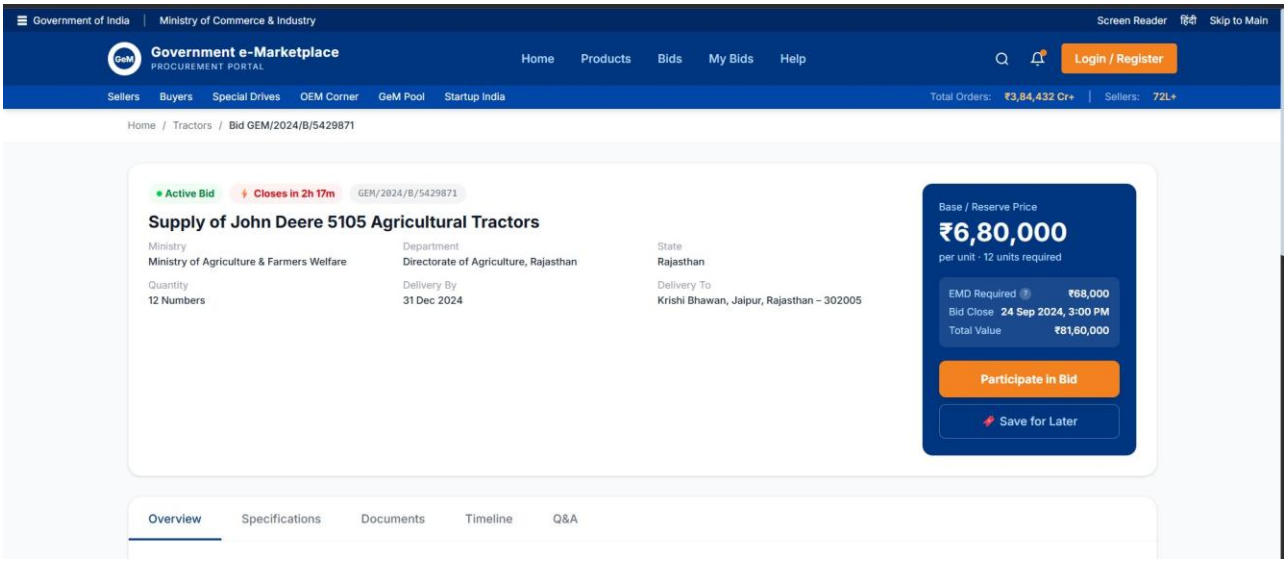
Browse by Category and featured Agricultural Tractors banner

PAGE - 5



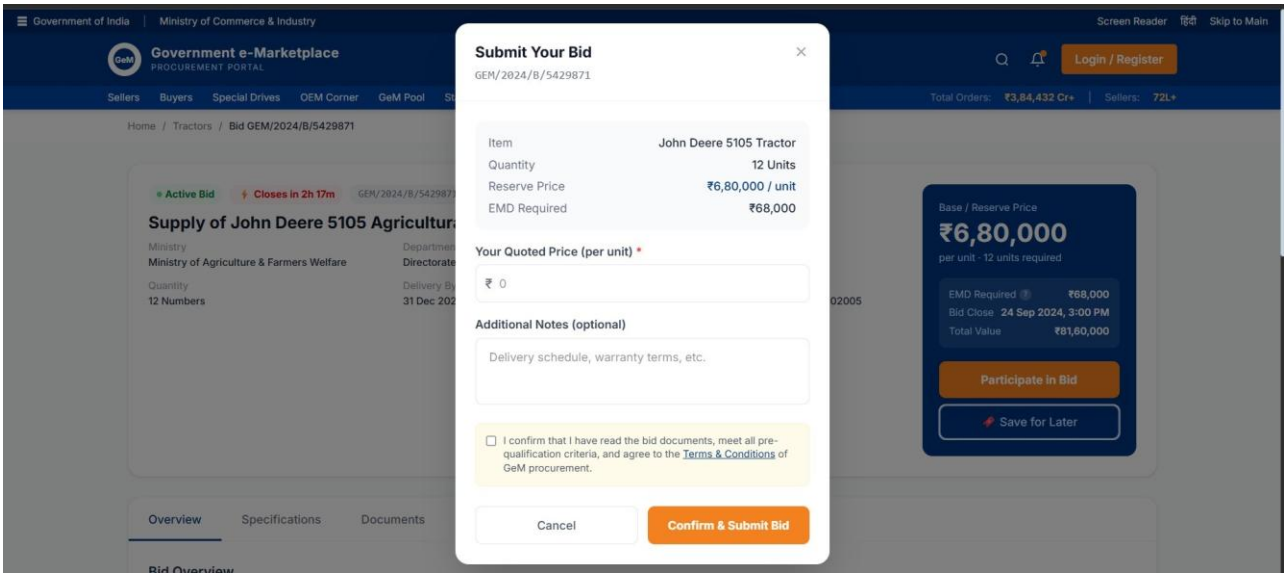
Agricultural Tractors listing with filters

PAGE - 6



Bid details page

PAGE - 7



Submit Your Bid modal